

HONEY POSSUM

This diminutive species is the only member of the family Tarsipedidae. It has fewer teeth than other possums and a long, brush-covered tongue for probing flowers.

HONEY POSSUM

Tarsipes rostratus

Inhabiting heathland and woodland in S.W. Australia, this possum is a specialized feeder on nectar and pollen.

6.5–9 cm
2½–3½ in

long, pointed snout



FEATHER-TAILED GLIDERS

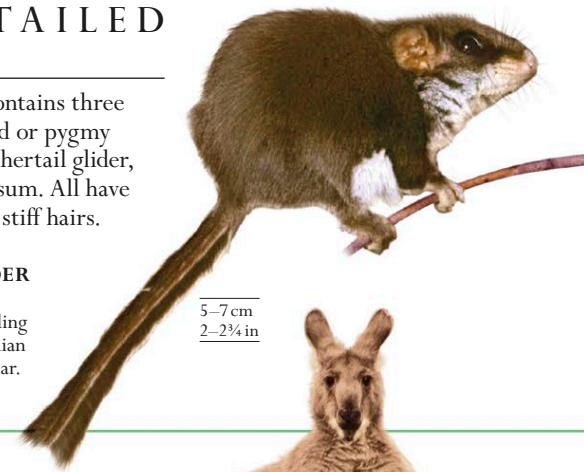
The family Acrobatidae contains three species – the feather-tailed or pygmy glider, the broad-toed feathertail glider, and the feather-tailed possum. All have tails fringed with rows of stiff hairs.

FEATHER-TAILED GLIDER

Acrobates pygmaeus

This species is the smallest gliding marsupial. It lives in E. Australian forests, where it feeds on nectar.

5–7 cm
2–2¾ in



KANGAROOS AND RELATIVES

The kangaroos and wallabies of the family Macropodidae are medium to large animals, with long hind legs for jumping. The hind feet lack a first toe, a fleshy sheath encompasses the second and third toes, forming a short grooming claw, and the strong, elongated fourth and fifth toes are weight-bearing.

66–92 cm
26–36 in

red-brown
upperparts

RED KANGAROO

Osphranter rufus

The largest extant marsupial, this kangaroo is widespread in Australia, where it lives in savanna grassland and desert.

45–53 cm
18–21 in



0.7–1.4 m
2¼–4½ ft

57–108 cm
22½–42½ in

COMMON WALLAROO

Osphranter robustus

Widespread throughout most of mainland Australia, the common or hill wallaroo often seeks shade in rocky outcrops.

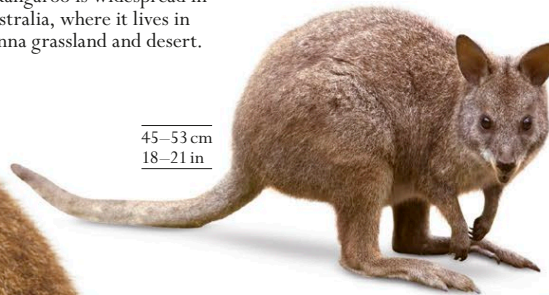


60–85 cm
23½–34 in

PARMA WALLABY

Notamacropus parma

Native to the mountains of the Great Dividing Range in Australia, the parma wallaby inhabits a range of forest habitats.



AGILE WALLABY

Notamacropus agilis

Unusually for wallabies, this species occurs in both Australia and New Guinea, where it inhabits grassland and open woodland.



0.7–2.2 m
2¼–7¼ ft

0.9–2.3 m
3–7½ ft

EASTERN GREY KANGAROO

Macropus giganteus

Widespread in E. Australia, this species lives in dry woodland, scrub, and shrub. A subspecies is found in Tasmania.



joey in pouch

WESTERN GREY KANGAROO

Macropus fuliginosus

The only kangaroo that does not reproduce using the method of delayed implantation of the embryo in the uterus, this species occurs in southern Australia, including Kangaroo Island.



RED-NECKED WALLABY

Notamacropus rufogriseus

This species lives in coastal forest and scrub in southeastern Australia, including the islands of Tasmania and the Bass Strait.

long tail used
for support at
rest, for balance
when moving

